

US equities slip as yields rise and oil spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

All major US equity indices closed lower on Tuesday, with the **S&P 500** down **0.22%** to 7,801.77 and the Dow Jones off **0.66%** at 51,179.87. Higher Treasury yields and a near-2% jump in WTI crude pressured risk assets.

Defensive health-care ETF **XLV** posted the only sector gain, up **+1.03%**, while the VIX rose modestly to 15.08, indicating lingering volatility.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,801.77	-0.22%	
Dow Jones	51,179.87	-0.66%	
Nasdaq 100	31,160.08	-0.21%	
Russell 2000	2,793.20	-1.31%	
VIX	15.08	+0.47%	
10Y Yield	5.28%	+0.15%	
WTI Crude	90.77	+2.82%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AAPL	336.67	+0.91%
AMZN	259.92	+1.42%
XLV	168.81	+1.03%
META	721.31	-2.38%
GS	887.21	-1.11%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Q3 EPS	2.87
Revenue	24.1 bn
YoY Growth	+12.4%
Guidance	-5.2% YoY for Q4

Nvidia reported solid Q3 earnings, beating estimates on the top line but trimmed its Q4 guidance, sending the stock down **0.74%**. The downgrade reflects concerns over a slowdown in AI-related spend as the macro backdrop tightens.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 5.28%
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:30, Initial Jobless Claims 04:30
- Oil price surge to 90.77 USD per barrel (+2.82%)
- Gold up to 4,149.00 USD per ounce (+0.20%)

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated; oil supply concerns keep WTI bullish.
- China's manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.9, adding pressure on global growth outlook.

- Eurozone core inflation eases to 2.6%, supporting a dovish ECB stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Oct 14 09:30	MSFT	Cloud spend trends, AI margin impact
Oct 15 10:00	JPM	Net interest income vs higher rates
Oct 16 08:45	TSLA	Q3 deliveries and Model Y pricing
Oct 17 09:00	META	Ad revenue recovery, AI ad products

Stocks worth watching

- **AVGO** – up **+0.19%**; strong semiconductor demand despite rate pressure.
- **XLE** – down **-0.61%**; oil rally may boost energy earnings.
- **XLB** – down **-1.51%**; materials sector vulnerable to slower global growth.
- **BTC** – down **-3.24%**; crypto sell-off amid risk-off sentiment.
- **DXY** – up **+0.05%**; dollar strength pressures commodities.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further 10-year yield rise above 5.35%.
- WTI breaching \$95, tightening energy margins.
- Negative surprise in upcoming tech earnings (MSFT, NVDA).

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Fed signals pause or rate cut.
- Gold climbs above \$4,200, indicating safe-haven demand.
- Strong Q3 earnings from health-care sector (XLV).

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

CNBC — Economic Calendar

SEC — Company Filings

Financial Times — Commentary